



PasswordBox: Download now!

A free password manager that allows users to securely store, retrieve and sync passwords and other personal data anytime, anywhere, on any device <http://dgit.in/dpwndbox>

Inside Google Earth

What does Google Earth's space clicker look like? Here's an inside look at the observatory where the magic happens: <http://dgit.in/1j3mkBE>

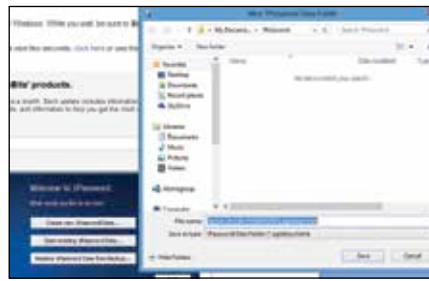
stores all your login and passwords generated through 1Password directly on your PC or Mac. This database file can be easily synced using services like Dropbox, Box.com, or Google Drive in case you want to keep using 1Password through multiple devices, either at work or home. Just ensure that whatever master password you set for accessing the database file is long, strong and difficult to guess, as this will also be the same password that you enter into 1Password's browser extension.

Next step is obviously to open the 1Password vault and install a browser plugin of your choice. While logging into the browser plugin of 1Password, you'll have to enter the same master password you used to encrypt your database file with. Once you get past the login section of the browser plugin, you'll identify it with a key icon on your browser's taskbar.

Whenever you enter the username and password for a new website, 1Password gives you a visual cue at the top of the browser page whether you want to save the login credentials in your database. If you click yes, immediately the credentials are synced with 1Password's program and database file.

The tool also supports the creation of multiple password vaults to share with family members or coworkers. Create extra vaults, copy items to them, and just click share. This is for now a Mac-only feature, but it's slated to arrive on other platforms very soon. Here's how you create and share vaults.

- Create a new vault (1Password > New Vault...)
- Customize its icon, color, and Master Password (you can even use photos from your Mac!)
- Copy some items to this new secondary vault (select any item, click the sharing arrow and choose your new vault as the destination)
- Place the vault in a shared Dropbox folder or other location (1Password > Preferences > Sync)
- Have your family members or coworkers use 1Password 4 for Mac to add your new vault
- Enjoy 1Password's new Shared Vault awesomeness



Creating a new 1Password database

KeePass: This is a free, lightweight, robust, open source and cross-platform password management utility that does not offer all the features offered by LastPass or 1Password, but it covers all the bases effectively to make it a lucrative tool to use. You can put all your passwords in one database, which is locked with one master key or a key file. So you only have to remember one single master password or select the key file to unlock the whole database.

It's largely similar to 1Password, but because it's open source, KeePass isn't as easy to use as other applications straight after downloading and takes some getting used to. It's built for Windows, so it involves getting your hands dirty with add-ons if you want it to run on anything else. But therein lies its unique appeal. You exert complete control over every aspect of the tool and your experience, which is not a claim that 1Password or LastPass can't entirely make. Once you create a master password and link it to a database file (.kdbx), and use the same password to login through a browser plugin (like ChromeIPass), you effectively follow the exact same process like 1Password's to fill in passwords while visiting websites.

And remember to always keep the database synced using cloud syncing services to have the database file at hand whenever you need it. As long as you don't lose this file or forget its master password, you'll always have access to your passwords and logins – even if this file is stolen or falls into wrong hands, the effectiveness of its master password and its encrypted nature will ensure that no one can ever decipher your passwords.

Use a pen drive for password management

Services like KeePass and 1Password can

be used in conjunction with a hardware key – like a USB pen drive – to fundamentally alter how you memorise and save passwords in your head or on a database file. A company called Yubico is in the business of making USB keys which are nothing but on-ground, hardware one-time-password generators and authenticators. Using a Yubico USB password key lets you “hold” a password (much like a door key) and relieves you from the burden of “thinking” a password to store. It's an important distinction that one must understand.

A \$25 Yubico key (or Yubikey) works much like a standard door key to gain access to your password vault in 1Password or KeyPass, and both utilities recognize and support the device. Yubikeys operate in two modes: static and OTP. In static password mode, Yubikeys can enter a very strong password to pair with your 1Password or KeePass login (without the need of Internet, too). Follow these steps for KeePass:



Use the KeePass chrome extension

- When creating a new KeePass database (main menu: File > New) or changing the master key of an existing database (main menu: File > Change Master Key), first make sure that in the key dialog the input focus is currently in the master password field (marked red on the screenshot on the right).
- Then insert your YubiKey and press its button. YubiKey will enter a strong password for you.
- After successfully changing the key, don't forget to save the database to apply the new key.

There's a catch here: now the onus is on you to not lose the Yubikey, as long as you need to keep using KeePass and 1Password's DB file made with Yubikey's hardware authentication.